First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here*.

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH VISION STATEMENT

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH MISSION STATEMENT

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: 8 AM to 11 AM weekdays.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: T-W-F, 9am-12pm
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

OUR WORSHIP SERVICE IS BROADCAST OVER THE LOCAL PUBLIC ACCESS CHANNEL 1079 ON SUNDAYS AT 4 PM.

SCRIPTURE READER: Sandy Cristman

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"WE WELCOME YOU AND SERVE ALL THROUGH FAITH."

WORSHIP WITH US:

AUGUST 21, 2022

10AM

REV. JESSICA MOORE, PASTOR
ERIN GRAINGER, MUSIC AND CHORAL DIRECTOR
STEPHAN CONRADY, ORGANIST
SUE POWERS, ADMINISTRATIVE ASSISTANT
27 CHURCH STREET, ST. ALBANS, VT 05478
802-524-4555

INFO@FIRSTCONGREGATIONALSTALBANS.ORG
WWW.FIRSTCONGREGATIONALSTALBANS.ORG

WE GATHER AS GOD'S PEOPLE

CENTERING WORDS**:**
"Compassion leads to action. Be the compassion of Jesus"

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

PRELUDE *Hymn for freedom* O. Peterson

WELCOME AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

CALL TO WORSHIP[1]

One: Our God knows us intimately.
Many: God, you knew us before we knew us before we knew ourselves.
One: Our God is holy.
Many: Holy God, you consecrate us.
One: Our God will reassure.
Many: Holy God, you will give us words to speak.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*PLEASE STAND IF YOU ARE ABLE

[1]UCC, WORSHIP WAYS

MUSIC, COPYRIGHT PERMISSIONS: CCLI #4799426 AND SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and a full pantry, fridge, and freezer stock of food.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:

- Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- First Congregational Church of St Albans
- Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
- Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
- As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative.

WH works with local housing case workers from:

- F/GI Community Action
- Voices Against Violence
- Samaritan House
- Restorative Justice Center
- Pathways

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

MORNING PRAYER[1] **(Unison)**
Mothering God, we rejoice that you placed us in the womb and called us forth. You called us forth to build and to plant. Give us the blueprint as we build and bless our hands as we plant. We rejoice in knowing that our steps are guided by you, and you are reliable. We delight ourselves in your presence and give thanks as you deliver us from fear and let your love have its way in us. Embolden us to speak your truth to power and let the power of your truth always be evident in us. Amen.

HYMN* ***"As the Deer"*** BB 4

PRAYER OF CONFESSION[1] **(Unison)**
Transforming God, too often we have been afraid to speak out against the injustices of this world. We have worshipped in ways that made us feel good rather than honor you in our words and deed. Show us the path to faithful living. Show us how to build beloved and just communities. Teach us how to do your work in this world. Empower us to plant seeds of love, faith, and hope. May we bloom where we have been planted to your glory. Amen

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

TIME WITH CHILDREN

SPECIAL MUSIC *PRELUDE FOR PIANO, MELLOTRON & ARPEGGIATOR*
(FROM "NOCTURNAL RAINBOWS") S. CONRADY

SCRIPTURE READING JEREMIAH 1:4-10
LUKE 13:10-17

MORNING REFLECTION
"A piece of the puzzle"

HYMN*
"He's got the whole world in his hands" BB 20

THE THANKSGIVING

SHARING OUR JOYS AND CONCERNS

PRAYER OF THE PEOPLE ~

Lord's Prayer
Our Father who art in heaven hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

THE DEPARTURE

Benediction

HYMN*
"I have decided to follow Jesus" BB 27

POSTLUDE *Wir glauben an den Einen Gott* German hymn

ANNOUNCEMENTS:

Please Welcome Guest Worship Leader: Sandy Cristman

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:
Thank You**, Greg Beeman** for coming in during the week to meet with vendors in order to address building maintenance.

Thank you, **Paula Kane** for the donation of office supplies.

Pastor Jessica's Vacation August 2-23
Emergency pastoral care will be covered by Rev. Preston Fuller of St. Paul's Methodist Church (802-524-5632)

Summer Music
Do you, or a friend, sing or play an instrument? You are invited to "pray twice" and share music during Sunday worship! Contact Erin during coffee hour or during the week through the office or firstcongregationalmusic@gmail.com

Bible Study is on Summer Break!
We will resume in the September.